Lesson 30: Project: Make a How-To Video

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 3: Zero Waste

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): 3.7 Unit Project - Make a "How to" Video.

In this lesson

You will make a short "how to" video that teaches people how to do something. First you will study how Lauren's toothpaste video is organised. Then you will plan your steps, write a script, practise explaining it to your AI tutor, and record yourself with your phone.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Name the usual parts of a "how to" video, in order.
- Plan and write a script with an introduction, at least 3 steps and a conclusion.
- Mark the content words and the linked words in your script.
- Explain a task clearly, looking at the camera and speaking loudly enough.
- Use the rhythm of content and function words, and connected speech.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
"how to" video	a video that teaches you how to do or make something, step by step	Zero Waste Toothpaste
introduction	the start: you say what you will teach	This video is about how to make zero waste toothpaste.
benefit	a good result; a reason to learn something	It's quick and easy to make.
step	one part of a task, in order	Your video must include at least 3 steps.
tip	a short piece of helpful advice	If it's too liquid, put it in the freezer.
conclusion	the end: final tips or a summary	End with some final tips and/or a summary.
transcript (script)	the words you are going to say, written down	Circle the content words in your transcript.
storyboard	a plan: what you say and what the camera shows in each part	Complete the storyboard before you make your video.

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
volume	how loud your voice is	Speak loudly enough to be heard comfortably.
eye contact	looking at a person; in a video, looking at the camera	Look directly at the camera.

Rules and explanations

What your video must include

- **Introduction:** explain what you will teach.
- **Why:** explain why this skill is important, helpful or interesting to learn.
- **Steps:** at least 3 steps. Show yourself doing the task and explain each step.
- **Conclusion:** end with some final tips and/or a summary.
- **Transcript:** write down what you are going to say. Circle the content words in each sentence. Draw lines between words that are linked. Practise reading it with the correct pronunciation.

Possible topics

How to make the perfect cup of coffee; change a bicycle tire; post on Instagram; make a TikTok video; make or do something from your country or culture. Choose something that interests you and that other people would like to learn.

Why are we doing this?

- To practise speaking skills: volume, eye contact and organisation.
- To use the pronunciation from this unit: stress and rhythm (content words and function words) and linking in connected speech.

Self-check list (from the book's rubric)

- **Content:** introduction, why the skill is important, at least 3 steps, conclusion.
- **Organisation and clarity:** well organised, interesting and clear; few grammar or vocabulary mistakes.
- **Delivery:** you speak loudly enough and look directly at the camera. You know most of it by heart and do not read from notes.
- **Pronunciation:** you are clear and easy to understand. You use rhythm and connected speech. You do not sound "robotic" (reading word by word).
- **Visual:** you show 3 or more steps while you explain each step.
- **Transcript:** your content words and links are marked.

Practice

1. Analyse a "how to" video. Watch "Zero Waste Toothpaste" again (see Watch online). Take notes for each question.

- What is the video about? This video is about how to make _____.
- What are the benefits of learning to do this?
- What tools or ingredients do you need?
- What are the steps?
- What tips, helpful advice or important information were included?
- How does the video end?

2. Brainstorm and plan. Choose your topic. Answer the same questions for your own video.

- What is the video about? This video is about how to _____.
- What are the benefits of learning to do this?
- What tools or ingredients do you need?
- What are the steps? (at least 3)
- What tips, helpful advice or important information will you include?
- How will the video end?

3. Storyboard. Before you record, plan six parts. For each part, write your script (what you will say) and a note or a small drawing of what the camera will show.

Part	Script: What are you going to say?	Video: What will you see on the camera?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

4. Mark your transcript. Circle the content words in each sentence. Draw lines between linked words (final consonant + vowel, or the same consonant). Read it aloud three times.

5. Practise with your tutor. Explain your task to the AI tutor, step by step, without reading (see Speak with your tutor). Ask what was not clear. Improve your script.

6. Record. Record yourself with your phone. Your face must be seen. Show the task with your hands while you explain each step. Look at the camera and speak loudly enough. Then watch your video and check it with the self-check list. Record it again if needed.

7. After the project. The book asks students to watch two classmates' videos and post a comment or question. Instead, watch your own video as if a classmate made it. Write one thoughtful comment and

one question. Then find a "how to" video online about a topic you like, and do the same.

Speak with your tutor

- "I am going to make a how-to video about [my topic]. Ask me questions to help me plan: the benefits, the tools, the steps and the tips."
- "Let me explain my steps to you without reading. After each step, ask me one question if something is not clear."
- "Here is my script. Tell me if I have an introduction, at least 3 steps and a conclusion. Then correct my grammar."
- "Check my transcript: did I choose the right content words? Then I will read it aloud. Tell me which words I should stress more."
- "You watched my video. Ask me three questions about it, like people do in video comments."

Read aloud

- This VID·e·o is about how to MAKE ZE·ro WASTE TOOTH·paste. (↘)
- How to MAKE the PER·fect CUP of COF·fee. (of = /ə/ before a consonant)
- How to CHANGE a BI·cy·cle TIRE. (chan-ʤə)
- GIVE an in·tro·DUC·tion. (gi-vən)
- END with some FI·nal TIPS. (↘)
- LOOK di·RECT·ly at the CAM·er·a. (↘)

Writing task

Write the transcript (script) for your "how to" video.

- Introduction: say what you will teach.
- Explain why this skill is important, helpful or interesting.
- At least 3 steps, in order.
- Conclusion: some final tips and/or a summary.
- Mark it: circle the content words in each sentence, and draw lines between words that are linked.

Watch online

- Zero Waste Toothpaste, Lauren's "how to" video (watch it again to analyse it): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DIpTXQl7qTo

Answer key

1. (book)

- About: how to make zero waste toothpaste: toothpaste that doesn't produce any trash, such as the toothpaste tube.
- Benefits: toothpaste tubes are difficult, if not impossible, to recycle; this toothpaste works extremely well; it's quick and easy to make.
- Tools and ingredients: 2 tablespoons of organic coconut oil; 1 tablespoon of baking soda; fifteen to twenty drops of organic essential oil (for flavor); a bowl and something to stir it together.
- Steps: combine the coconut oil and baking soda, and add the essential oil for flavor; mix it together; use a spoon to put a small amount of the paste onto your toothbrush; brush your teeth.
- Tips: it doesn't foam up like normal toothpaste; it might be a little saltier than you're used to; if the paste is too hard, put it under some warm water for a few minutes; if it's too liquid, put it in the freezer for a little while.
- Ending: she says "now you're ready to make ..." and "thank you so much for watching". She gives her website and YouTube channel in case you want more information.

2 to 4. (example answer) Topic: how to make fresh mint tea.

1. Script: "Hi everybody! Today I'm going to show you how to make fresh mint tea." Video: me in the kitchen, smiling at the camera.
2. Script: "It's quick and easy, and it's a great drink after dinner. You need tea, fresh mint, hot water and sugar." Video: the things on the table.
3. Script: "First, boil some water." Video: the water boiling.
4. Script: "Next, put a few mint leaves in a teapot. Add a spoon of tea." Video: my hands putting mint and tea in the teapot.
5. Script: "Then pour the hot water into the teapot and wait three or four minutes." Video: pouring the water.
6. Script: "Finally, pour the tea into a glass and add sugar if you like. My tip: always use fresh mint. Thanks for watching!" Video: the glass of tea, close up.

Marked: "NEXT, PUT a FEW MINT LEAVES in a TEA·pot." Links: put a (pu-də), leaves in (leave-zin), in a (i-nə).

My notes